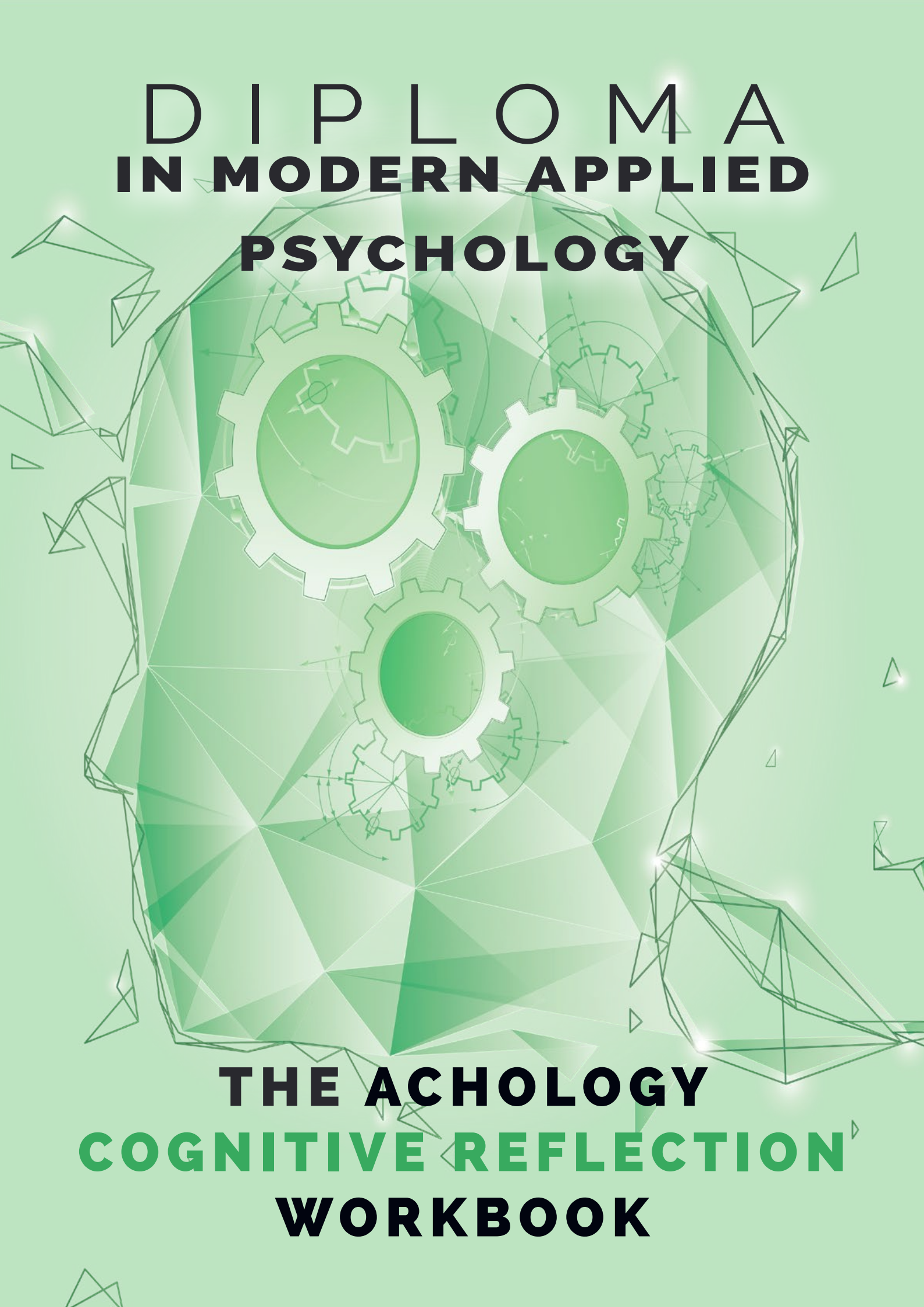


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background of the cover is a light green color. It features a large, abstract geometric shape in the center, composed of many overlapping triangles in various shades of green. Inside this shape, there are three large, interlocking gears. The gears are white with green outlines and centers. The background is also decorated with a wireframe skull, which is a green outline of a human head. The skull is composed of many small triangles and lines, giving it a geometric, low-poly appearance. There are also some smaller, floating geometric shapes like triangles and lines around the main skull shape.

THE ACHOLOGY
COGNITIVE REFLECTION
WORKBOOK

THE ACHOLOGY COGNITIVE REFLECTION WORKBOOK

Self-Reflection Questions:

1. What role does extreme thinking play in your day-to-day decision making?
2. In what areas of your life do you rely more upon your feelings than facts?
3. What cognitive distortions can you identify as being actively at play in your life?
4. What 'drama triangle' roles have you historically played in your relationships?
5. In what ways can you relate to 'Superman Complex' or 'Imposter Syndrome'?
6. In what aspects of your life do you operate out of a growth mindset and why?



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7. In what aspects of your life do you operate out of a fixed mindset and why?

8. In what ways will your relationships improve if you master the ABCs of CBT?

9. In what ways have unhelpful cognitive distortions impacted your attitude towards work?

10. In what ways have unhelpful cognitive distortions impacted your attitude towards people?



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Questions for Self-Reasoning:

If you need any clarification on what these questions are challenging you to think about, please refer back to The Fifteen Common Cognitive Distortions Workbook.

1. Am I jumping to the worst possible conclusion? (Catastrophising)
2. Am I thinking in extreme (all-or-nothing) terms? (Black-and-white thinking)
3. Am I using words like 'always' and 'never' to draw generalised conclusions from a particular event? (Overgeneralising)
4. Am I predicting the future instead of waiting to see what happens? (Fortune-telling)
5. Am I jumping to conclusions about what other people are thinking of me? (Mind-reading)



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6. Am I focusing on the negative and overlooking the positive? (Mental filtering)

7. Am I discounting positive information or twisting a positive into a negative? (Disqualifying the positive)

8. Am I globally putting myself down as a failure, worthless, or useless? (Labelling)

9. Am I listening too much to my negative gut feelings instead of looking at the objective facts? (Emotional reasoning)

10. Am I taking an event or someone's behaviour too personally or blaming myself and overlooking other factors? (Personalising)

11. Am I using words like 'should', 'must', 'ought', and 'have to' to make rigid rules about myself, the world, or other people? (Demanding)



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12. Am I telling myself that something is too difficult or unbearable or that 'I can't stand it' when it's hard to bear, but it is bearable and worth tolerating? (Low frustration tolerance)

Socratic Questions:

Thought to be Questioned:

What is the evidence for this thought?:

What is the evidence against this thought?:

Am I basing this thought on facts or feelings?:



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Is this thought black and white? Write down a more complex way of viewing this thought:

Am I possibly misinterpreting the evidence at hand? Am I making any assumptions? Write down alternative interpretations of the evidence and alternative assumptions:

Might other people have different interpretations of the same situation? What are they?

Am I looking at all the evidence or just that which supports my thoughts? What am I overlooking or ignoring?

Could my thought be an exaggeration of what's true? If yes, how so?



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Am I having this thought out of habit (i.e. have I had this thought before) or is this a new thought supported by new facts? Write down the times you've had this thought before or write down the evidence which suggests this thought is entirely new.

Did someone pass this thought/belief onto me? If so, are they a reliable source?

Is my thought a likely scenario or is it just the worst-case scenario?



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Thought Diary:

	Where were you?
	Emotion or Feeling?
	Negative automatic thought
	Evidence supporting the thought
	Evidence not supporting the thought
	Alternative Thought
	Emotion or feeling



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ABCDE Worksheet:

	Antecedents What factors preceded the problematic behaviour?
	Behaviour What is the problematic behaviour?
	Consequences What was the outcome of the problematic behaviour?



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Cognitive distortions have a way of causing havoc in our lives if we allow them to. This sort of unhelpful thinking can be undone, but it requires effort, patience and lots of practice — every day! If you want to put an end to these irrational thinking patterns, you can start by trying out the 'STOPP Card Strategy'.

Learning this one essential skill can help you to take control of your emotions and your life. Take a few minutes to read through the steps below and start practising! You can print off the downloadable STOPP Cards and keep them in your wallet or purse so that they're easy to pull out and use as a prompt when those cognitive distortions show up!

1. **STOP:** Don't act impulsively. Wait.
2. **TAKE A BREATH** Breathe in and out a few times slowly.
3. **OBSERVE** What am I focusing on? What am I thinking about? What is it that I'm reacting to? What am I feeling in my body?
4. **PERSPECTIVE** Consider the bigger picture. Is this fact or is it opinion? Could there be a different way of looking at this? Consider what someone else would say about it? How does this affect other people? What advice would I offer a friend in the same situation? How important is this situation right now?
5. **PRACTISE WHAT WORKS** Consider the consequences. What is the best thing to do? Do whatever will help the most!

How to use STOPP

- Practise the first two steps frequently for a few days - several times every day.
- Read through the steps regularly.
- Carry the STOPP Card reminders with you
- Practise STOPP by working through each of the steps several times a day, every day...even when you don't need it.
- Start using it for minor upsets - when you notice yourself responding emotionally to something that's happening.
- Over time, you'll find that you can use it for more major and distressing situations. Like any new skill or habit, it will become automatic with practice!

A Further Explanation of the Steps

Stop - say it to yourself (in your head) as soon as you feel your mind and/or your body reacting to some kind of trigger. This helps to put in a space between the trigger (whatever we're reacting to) and our response. The earlier you use STOPP, the more effective and the easier it will be.

Take a deep breath - breathing a little deeper and slower will calm you down and lower the physical reaction of adrenaline/emotion. Focusing on your breathing means you're not so focused on the thoughts/feelings regarding the distress. This helps your mind to clear, and you'll start thinking more rationally/logically.

Observe - become aware of the thoughts going through your mind, notice what you're feeling in your body, and pay attention to the urge to react impulsively. We can start to identify the vicious cycle of anxiety, anger, sadness, etc. This helps us to defuse from those thoughts and feelings and reduce their power and control as a result.

Perspective - this is about thinking differently - the thought challenging of CBT. If we step back emotionally from any situation, we'll start to see the bigger picture, reducing the weight of those distressing beliefs. You can do this by asking yourself questions.

Practise what works - this is about doing things differently - the behavioural change of CBT. Rather than reacting out of impulse which often has unhelpful consequences, we can choose a more helpful and positive response.



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STOPP

TAKE A DEEP BREATH

OBSERVE: What am I thinking about?
What is it that I'm reacting to?
What am I feeling in my body

PERSPECTIVE: Consider the bigger picture
How would someone else see this?
Identify the facts. What's actually true?

PRACTISE WHAT WORKS: Now take action.
What's the best thing I can do here, for
me/others/the situation?



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Putting Thoughts on Trial

In this exercise, you will put a thought on trial by acting as a defence attorney, prosecutor and judge to determine the accuracy of the thought.

Prosecution and Defence:

Gather evidence in support of your thought, then gather evidence against it. Evidence can be used if it's a verifiable fact; no interpretations, guesses or opinions!

Judge: Come to a verdict regarding your thought: is the thought accurate and fair? Are there other thoughts that could explain the facts?

The Thought:

The Defence: evidence for the thought

The Prosecution: evidence against the thought

The Judge's Verdict:



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QUESTIONS TO HELP FIND LIMITING BELIEFS

1. What is a problem or limitation that has held you back for a while?

2. What is it you would like to do/have, except something is stopping you from getting/doing it?

3. What is it that is REALLY stopping you from getting what you want?

4. This is a problem because?

5. And this means? (Repeat as many times as necessary)

6. What must you believe that makes this problem even exist?



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7. What is it you believe about YOURSELF that has made this a problem?

8. What do you believe about the WORLD that has made this a problem?

9. What is this problem an example of?

10....and what is THIS an example of?

11. When did you decide that your problem was a problem (roughly)?

12. At what point in your life did you by into this concept?



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13. What decision did you make that caused this problem to be born?

14. What does this problem mean to you?

15. What will life be like when you don't have this problem?

